

4.1 Editing Tools

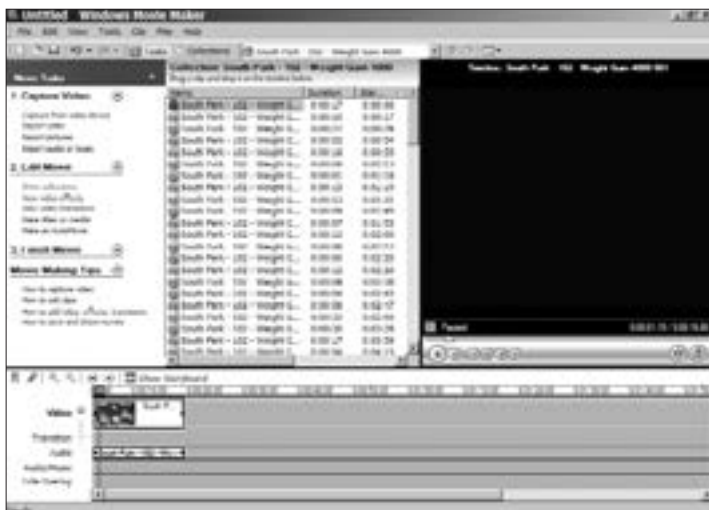
Generally, those serious about video editing don't flinch at paying for software, but if you're just looking to try your hand at it, a free alternative could perhaps be better suited for you. Let's start with the free tools and then get to the paid software. You need to first decide what your needs are.

4.1.1 Windows Movie Maker

www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/downloads/updates/moviemaker2.msp

Windows Movie Maker (WMM) is something that everyone with Windows XP already has on their computer. This free tool from Microsoft can be found by going to **Start > Programs > Windows Movie Maker**, or the geek way by going to **Start > Run**, typing in "moviemk" and pressing [Enter].

As with all Microsoft products, usability is top priority, and WMM is perhaps the easiest video editing software you will ever encounter. It has everything a novice would ever need. Of course,



Windows Movie Maker has a simple editing interface